

LEARNORA

THE PRACTICAL DIGITAL SKILLS LIBRARY

SOCIAL MEDIA MARKETING

A field guide to strategy, content,
community and measurable growth

For Indian beginners, creators and small businesses

2026 EDITION • WORKBOOK INCLUDED

Build a clear system. Publish with purpose. Learn from the evidence.

How to use this guide

One useful outcome matters more than posting everywhere. Work through the exercises with one real brand, service or creator profile in mind.

Your route through the book

Stage	What you will make	Pages
Foundation	A one sentence goal, audience and channel choice	4-8
Production	Content pillars, formats and briefs	9-14
Distribution	Calendar, publishing, community and enquiries	15-18
Improvement	Measurement, 30 day plan and worksheets	19-26

Start with a working example

Illustrative example: A Surat based sewing studio wants local enquiries for an offline course. Its first content goal is to help interested learners understand who the course suits, what they will learn and how to book a visit. This is a teaching example, not a real case study or predicted result.

USE THE MARGINS MENTALLY

Replace each example with your own audience, offer and city. Keep a separate document for your answers. The worksheets in this PDF can also be printed and filled by hand.

Reality check

Reach, followers and enquiries can fluctuate. No content cadence, posting time or format guarantees sales. The methods here are planning and testing recommendations. Platform features and definitions change; verify current settings in the linked official help pages before launching.

Inside the playbook

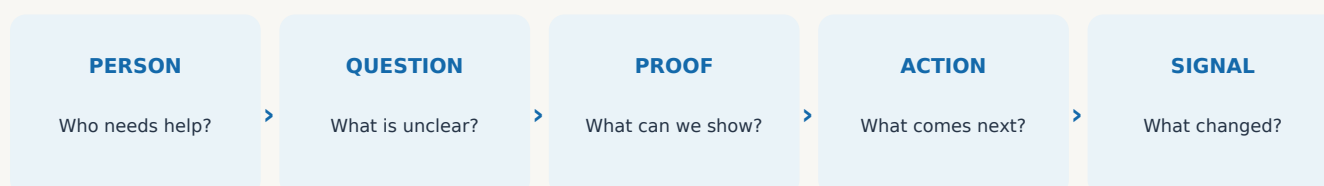
Section	Focus	Page
01 / Direction	Goal, audience, offer and channel	4
02 / Content system	Research, pillars, formats, hooks and production	9
03 / Publish & respond	Calendar, distribution, community, enquiries	15
04 / Measure & improve	Scorecard, diagnosis and experiments	19
05 / Execute	30 day plan and printable assets	22
Reference	Glossary and official sources	27

WHAT TO PREPARE

A phone, access to your social accounts, a simple spreadsheet or notebook, and permission to use any customer images or quotes. You can complete the first draft without buying software or advertising.

A useful order of operations

Choose the outcome first. Then define the person you want to help, the proof they need, the content that can provide it, the next action and the signal that tells you whether it worked. Repeat after reviewing real responses.



Pick one outcome

Social media is a channel for moving a specific person toward a useful next step. Write the outcome before choosing a format.

Goal	Useful content signal	Next action
Awareness	Relevant people discover the account	Visit profile or remember brand
Consideration	Saves, questions, meaningful views	Read details, follow or ask
Enquiries	Qualified messages or forms	Book call, visit or quote
Retention	Repeat questions answered; customers return	Use product, refer or reorder

Make the goal observable

Weak: “grow our Instagram.” Better: “Over the next month, test whether practical course demonstrations bring local learners to the profile and produce enquiries that mention the batch schedule.” This is a learning goal, not a promised target.

DECISION RULE

Choose one primary outcome for the next 30 days. Keep one secondary signal for context. Example: primary = qualified enquiries; secondary = profile visits. Do not replace enquiry quality with raw message count.

Primary outcome

Secondary signal

Decision date

Know the person behind the view

Useful content answers a decision or removes a doubt for a specific audience.

Build an audience snapshot

Question	Write a concrete answer
Who?	Role, situation, language and location if relevant
What are they trying to do?	One job, problem or desired improvement
What stops them?	Cost, trust, time, complexity or uncertainty
What proof matters?	Demonstration, process, specifications, examples or policies
Where do they ask?	Search, comments, DMs, friends or community groups

Listen before you invent ideas

- Collect 10 real questions from sales calls, DMs, reviews, search suggestions and customer support. Remove private details.
- Group questions into “what is it,” “how does it work,” “is it for me,” and “what happens next.”
- Mark the questions whose answers can be shown visually, compared side by side or demonstrated.

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

A first time student asks: “Can I join with no sewing experience?” A stronger post shows the first lesson, the tools provided and the enrolment steps instead of saying only “admissions open.”

Write the offer and action

Content performs a job only when the viewer understands what is available and what to do next.

The plain language offer formula

FILL IN

We help [specific person] do [outcome or task] through [method]. To learn whether it fits, [next action]. Avoid claims you cannot substantiate.

Illustrative example: “We teach beginners to operate a sewing machine and complete guided projects in offline classes in Surat. Message us for the current batch details.”

Profile audit

- Name field: use the name a customer would search. Bio: say who the account serves and what it offers.
- Link or contact button: test it from another phone; make the destination match the promised action.
- Pinned or featured content: answer “what,” “for whom,” and “how to start.” Update dated offers promptly.
- Proof: show work, process and policies accurately. Get consent before posting a customer image or private conversation.

Audience

Offer in one sentence

Single next action

Choose channels deliberately

Start with one primary channel you can support well; add a second only when you can adapt the content and respond there.

Channel	Often useful for	First practical test
Instagram	Visual demonstrations, local discovery, creator identity	One short demo plus a helpful carousel
Facebook	Local communities, existing Page audience	A clear Page post and relevant replies
YouTube	Searchable explanations and repeat questions	One concise answer video
LinkedIn	Professional expertise and B2B discussion	A specific lesson from real work
WhatsApp Business	Handling enquiries and follow-up with consent	Clear profile, labels and saved replies

These are editorial recommendations, not claims about which platform performs best. Compare your audience, content capacity and conversion path. Do not post identical creative everywhere without adapting the opening, crop, caption and action.

CHANNEL SCORE

Give each candidate 0–2 for audience presence, ability to make suitable content, ability to handle replies and clear next action. Choose the strongest total; use ties to favour the channel where you already have conversations.

Set up the measurement path

Before publishing, make it possible to connect a post with what happened next.

The minimum tracking setup

- Give each post an ID such as SM-01. Record date, platform, topic, format, goal and call to action in one sheet.
- For website links, use clearly named campaign parameters if your analytics setup supports them. Test the link before posting.
- For messages, ask a simple qualifier such as location or requirement. Log relevant enquiries without publishing private details.
- Decide what counts as a qualified enquiry before you see the numbers; for example, within service area and asking about the actual offer.

A compact content record

ID	Topic / promise	Action	Result to inspect
SM-01	What happens in a first class	Ask for batch details	Relevant DMs and question themes
SM-02	Compare two course options	Visit detail page	Link clicks and page enquiries

PRIVACY RULE

Collect only information needed to answer the request. Do not paste full customer phone numbers or chat screenshots into a shared reporting sheet.

Turn questions into pillars

Pillars make the account useful across the whole decision, rather than repeating sales announcements.

Pillar	Audience question	Example
Teach	How can I do or understand this?	A beginner demonstration
Show	What does the process look like?	Behind the scenes workflow
Prove	Why should I trust this?	Real work with permission and context
Decide	Is this suitable for me?	Comparison, eligibility, FAQ
Act	How do I begin?	Steps, availability, contact path

Build a small idea bank

For every audience question, write one teaching angle, one demonstration angle and one objection handling angle. This creates useful variations without changing the core promise.

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

Question: “What should I bring to the first class?” Teach = starter checklist. Show = kit laid out on a table. Decide = explain what the studio provides and what the learner needs to buy, if anything.

Three recurring questions

Pillars to prioritise

First nine post ideas

Match format to the job

Choose a format because it carries the explanation clearly, not because it is fashionable.

Format	Best suited to	Production note
Short video	Demonstration, process, myth correction	Show the useful action early; add clear captions
Carousel / slides	Steps, checklists, comparison	One idea per slide; readable on a phone
Single image	Announcement, product detail, one claim	Use one clear headline and enough context
Story / update	Timely answers, progress, reminders	Save lasting FAQs in an accessible place
Long video / article	Complex explanation or search intent	Answer the central question at the start

The “can the viewer use it?” test

- What does the viewer know or do after seeing this?
- Is the promise visible in the first screen or opening seconds?
- Can a stranger understand the post without reading five earlier posts?
- Is the next action proportional to the information given?

Use a reliable content brief

A two minute brief reduces vague drafts and unnecessary redesign.

Copy this brief for every asset

Field	Prompt
Post ID + goal	What is the single outcome of this post?
Audience moment	What question or situation triggers attention?
One promise	What specific answer will the viewer get?
Proof	What can you show, demonstrate or cite?
Format / shot list	What must appear on screen in order?
Action	What should a qualified viewer do next?
Review	Who approves claims, pricing, visuals and permissions?

ILLUSTRATIVE BRIEF

SM-03 | Goal: consideration | Audience: first time learner | Promise: see a beginner friendly first lesson | Proof: real class setup and tutor explanation | Format: 25 second vertical demo | Action: ask for the current batch schedule. Duration is an illustrative production choice.

Write openings that earn attention

A good hook identifies a real question and moves quickly to an answer. It does not need false urgency.

Four reusable opening patterns

Pattern	Illustrative opening
Specific question	"Can a complete beginner join our sewing class?"
Show the result first	"Here is the first stitch we teach, then how we get there."
Useful comparison	"Two ways to plan your first solar enquiry: what to prepare."
Mistake and fix	"If customers keep asking the same question, put this in your bio."

Caption structure

Context: name the situation. Value: give the steps, example or evidence. Action: invite one sensible next step. A caption is not a list of hashtags or an attempt to hide missing information.

COPY AND ADAPT

"If you are [audience] and wondering [question], start with [first step]. Then [second step]. Here is [proof or example]. If you need [specific next step], [contact instruction]."

Script a short teaching video

Keep one answer in one video. The sequence below is a production framework, not a platform rule.

Beat	What to show / say
Opening	Name the question while showing the subject.
Demonstration	Show the actual step or example, close enough to see.
Clarification	Explain one constraint, choice or mistake.
Next step	Point to the relevant detail, message prompt or longer resource.

Illustrative script: local training studio

Opening: “Never used a sewing machine? This is how a first lesson begins.” Demo: Show setup, threading and a guided practice line. Clarification: “The first exercise is practice, not a finished garment.” Action: “Ask us for the current beginner batch details.”

Production checklist

- Record in good light; clean the lens and ensure speech is audible.
- Keep important text clear of platform controls and verify the preview on a phone.
- Add captions for spoken instruction; check proper names and numbers manually.
- Do not borrow footage, music or testimonials without rights or permission.

Build a production batch

A repeatable batch makes a sustainable schedule possible without claiming any universal posting frequency.

A simple weekly workflow

Session	Output
Research	Review new questions and the previous week's replies; select three useful topics.
Brief	Write a promise, proof and action for each topic.
Capture	Film or photograph all required material; save original files clearly.
Edit & approve	Check facts, readability, rights, price and contact details.
Publish & respond	Schedule where supported; check the live post and answer replies.
Review	Record signals, useful comments and one change for next week.

FILE NAMING

Use a consistent pattern, for example "SM-07_first-lesson_reel_v2". Keep an approved final and the editable source. Archive old offers so they are not republished accidentally.

If you can make only one strong post in a week, publish one. Choose a pace you can sustain while answering people promptly. There is no reliable "magic number" of posts that guarantees growth.

Plan a calendar that has a purpose

The calendar is an editorial hypothesis. It should reflect customer questions and your ability to produce the work.

Illustrative seven day calendar

Day	Pillar / format	Promise	Action
Mon	Teach / carousel	Starter checklist	Save
Tue	Show / video	Process in action	Ask a question
Wed	Community / story	Answer a common reply	Send a question
Thu	Decide / comparison	Who each option suits	View details
Fri	Prove / image	Show verified work	Ask for scope
Sat	Act / FAQ	How to start	Enquire
Sun	Review	Log response and plan next topics	Internal task

This is an illustrative planning pattern, not a recommended daily posting requirement. Replace or remove rows based on capacity and audience demand.

CALENDAR TEST

Before scheduling, scan the sequence: Is every post a sales pitch? Does each promise have supporting proof? Are time sensitive details current? Is someone available to reply after publication?

Publish with a final check

A polished asset can still fail because the destination, permission or detail is wrong.

Preflight checklist

- Verify names, address or service area, date, offer terms, contact number and spelling.
- Open every link and test the destination on mobile. Confirm the page matches the call to action.
- Check the first frame and thumbnail, text size, crop, audio and captions.
- Confirm rights and consent for music, photos, customer work and testimonials.
- Where a post contains a paid or material connection, use clear disclosure and verify applicable rules and platform tools.
- Set a reply owner. After posting, inspect the live version and record its ID and link.

Useful built in tools

Meta Business Suite supports creating and scheduling Facebook and Instagram content; availability of specific formats can vary by account and surface. YouTube Studio provides content analytics. LinkedIn offers post analytics. Use the official help links at the back for current screens and definitions.

Treat replies as research

A conversation is an opportunity to clarify a need, not a reason to push a generic sales script.

The four step response

Step	What to do
Acknowledge	Answer the actual question in plain language.
Clarify	Ask for one missing detail needed to help, such as city, goal or size.
Guide	Give the suitable option, next step or honest limitation.
Record	Log recurring questions and qualified enquiry outcomes.

Copy ready reply templates

FIRST REPLY

"Thanks for asking. [Direct answer]. To suggest the right option, could you share [one relevant detail]? I can then send [specific information]."

WHEN IT DOES NOT FIT

"Based on [stated need], our [offer] may not be suitable because [reason]. You may want to look for [appropriate alternative or criterion]."

Avoid repeated unsolicited follow-ups. Respect a "no," protect personal details and obtain permission before using a conversation as content.

Connect content to enquiries

Make the handoff simple enough that a motivated viewer can complete it.

A practical path

Stage	Question to check	Example fix
Post	Is the promise understandable?	Show the actual process instead of a vague claim
Profile	Does the offer match the post?	Pin the matching FAQ
Destination	Does the link or message work?	Test the contact button and saved reply
Qualification	Do we know the need?	Ask one relevant question
Follow-up	Was the requested information sent?	Log owner, date and next action

ILLUSTRATIVE MESSAGE PROMPT

“Hi, I saw the beginner class video. Please send the current batch timings and location.”
This makes attribution and the first reply easier without pressuring the viewer.

If a business accepts online payments or runs a regulated offer, check current platform, consumer, tax and privacy requirements with official guidance or a qualified adviser. This guide does not provide legal or tax advice.

Read signals in context

A metric is useful when it answers a question. Compare similar posts over a meaningful period, not isolated screenshots.

Question	Signals to inspect	Caution
Did relevant people see it?	Reach or views, source, audience	Definitions differ across platforms
Did they care?	Watch behaviour, saves, comments, shares	An interaction is not a sale
Did they move forward?	Profile visits, link actions, enquiries	Check the destination and quality
Did we help a customer?	Answered needs, bookings, repeat questions	Keep a consistent record

Definitions worth keeping separate

Reach generally describes distinct accounts or people reached, while impressions count displays; platform definitions vary. A view may use a platform specific threshold. Qualified enquiry is your documented business definition. Do not combine unlike metrics across platforms as if identical.

CURRENT PLATFORM NOTE

YouTube's official help describes a 2026 change to how views are counted across formats. When reading older and newer reports, verify the current definition inside YouTube Studio before drawing a trend conclusion.

Use a weekly review sheet

Record observations and decisions, not just numbers.

Post ID	Purpose	Signal observed	Audience evidence	Next decision
SM-01	Consideration	Saves and questions	Asked about materials	Make materials checklist
SM-02	Enquiries	Messages	Many outside service area	State location earlier
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

The 20 minute review

- Identify one post that advanced the primary goal and one that did not.
- Read comments and messages for the exact words people used.
- Check whether topic, opening, format, offer or destination explains the difference.
- Choose one variable to change next week and write the prediction before publishing.

DECISION LOG TEMPLATE

“We observed [signal] on [post ID]. Our likely explanation is [hypothesis]. Next week we will change [one variable] and inspect [primary signal plus quality check].”

Diagnose before you redesign

Different weak signals call for different repairs.

What you see	First checks	Possible next test
Low relevant discovery	Topic, wording, distribution, account fit	Ask a clearer audience question
Views but little retention	Opening, visual clarity, pacing	Show the answer earlier
Engagement but few enquiries	Action clarity, profile, offer fit	Explain the next step
Many messages, low fit	Eligibility and service area	State who the offer suits
Clicks but no response	Destination, load, form friction	Test the journey on mobile

These are diagnostic hypotheses. A small account may not have enough data to isolate a cause. Do not claim that one metric proves a specific algorithm problem.

EXPERIMENT DISCIPLINE

Change one meaningful element when possible. Keep an example of the old version, record the date and compare against an appropriate baseline. If the sample is tiny, treat the result as a clue, not proof.

30 day action plan · days 1-15

Use this as a sequence of work, not a promise that measurable growth will happen in 30 days.

Days	Work	Deliverable
1-2	Choose one outcome and define a qualified action.	Goal statement
3-4	Collect real audience questions and objections.	Question bank
5	Audit offer, profile, link and reply path.	Profile checklist
6-7	Select primary channel and three to five pillars.	Channel rationale
8-9	Write briefs for your first content batch.	Three briefs
10-12	Capture and edit examples, demos or answers.	Approved assets
13	Test links, captions, rights and contact flow.	Publication check
14-15	Publish first assets and answer every relevant reply.	Live posts + reply log

IF TIME IS LIMITED

Complete days 1-9 and publish one excellent answer before building a large queue. A clear customer question and verified response are more useful than a full but generic calendar.

30 day action plan · days 16-30

Days	Work	Deliverable
16-18	Publish a second angle on an audience question; log replies.	Second test
19-20	Review audience language and message fit.	Updated question bank
21-22	Create a decision aid or comparison post.	Consideration asset
23-24	Check destination and response speed; fix friction.	Working handoff
25-26	Review comparable posts and enquiry quality.	Weekly scorecard
27-28	Repeat a useful topic in another suitable format.	Format test
29	Write one learning, one uncertainty and one next test.	Decision log
30	Plan the next month from evidence and capacity.	New calendar

What to carry forward

Keep the strongest audience questions, proof you can genuinely show, a production pace you can sustain, and a clear reply owner. Stop or revise formats that consume time without serving the chosen outcome.

One page strategy canvas

Print this page or copy the prompts into your planning document.

Offer / brand

Primary goal

Who exactly is it for?

Top audience problem

Proof we can show

Primary channel + reason

Three content pillars

One next action

Qualified enquiry definition

30 day review date

ONE SENTENCE STRATEGY

"We will help [audience] understand [specific problem or choice] through [content type and proof] on [primary channel], inviting [next action], and review [primary signal] after [period]."

Reusable content worksheet

Duplicate this page for each post. Fill the proof and review line before you publish.

Post ID / owner

Audience question

Pillar / outcome

One sentence promise

Evidence or demonstration

Format / shot list

Opening line

Caption key points

Call to action

Rights / approvals

Publish date / link

Result / next iteration

Quick reference: common mistakes

Mistake	Better practice
Posting for “everyone”	Choose a person, moment and question.
Selling in every post	Teach, show, prove and help people decide.
Copying a trend blindly	Check whether the format can carry your answer.
Vague claims	Show method, scope and substantiated proof.
No next step	Offer one clear action suited to the post.
Ignoring replies	Assign an owner and capture recurring questions.
Judging one post in isolation	Review comparable work and business outcomes.
Treating views as customers	Track enquiry quality and the handoff.
Using unapproved customer material	Get consent and document rights.

A PRACTICAL NEXT MOVE

Choose one question from a real customer. Write the answer in two sentences. Show the answer in the simplest suitable format. Publish it with one relevant next step, then log what people actually ask.

Sources & further reading

Official sources checked 28 September 2026. Interface labels, eligibility and metric definitions may change. These links support platform specific statements; the planning frameworks are Learnora recommendations.

Instagram Help — professional accounts and insights

<https://www.facebook.com/help/instagram/1714412405508502>

Instagram Help — account and content insights

<https://www.facebook.com/help/instagram/1533933820244654>

Meta Business Help — create and schedule content

<https://www.facebook.com/business/help/942827662903020>

YouTube Help — Analytics overview

<https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/9002587>

YouTube Help — content performance and view definitions

<https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/12220281>

LinkedIn Help — post analytics

<https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a523040/>

How to verify a platform claim

Open the relevant help page, check its update date and account eligibility, then compare it with the feature available in your own account. Record the definition used for a metric in any client report.

Plain language glossary

Term	Working meaning
Content pillar	A recurring type of audience question or value.
Hook	The opening that makes the topic clear.
Call to action	The one next step you ask a viewer to take.
Reach	Distinct audience reached according to the platform definition.
Impressions	Displays of content; one person may generate more than one.
Retention	How long people keep watching, per platform report.
Qualified enquiry	A message or form meeting your written fit criteria.
Conversion path	The steps between seeing content and completing the desired action.
Hypothesis	A proposed explanation to test, not an established fact.

Use platform native definitions when reporting. Screens, availability and metric names can differ by account and over time.

Make the next post useful.

Start with one real question. Show a clear answer.
Offer a sensible next step. Learn from the reply.

YOUR NEXT 20 MINUTES

1. Choose one audience question you heard this week.
2. Fill in the content worksheet on page 25.
3. Capture a real answer and test the contact path.